

Module 6 · A1 · Foundations

Numbers, prices, dates and time

The details listening questions test most — and the part of French counting that trips everyone up.

YOU'LL BE ABLE TO

- ✓ Say and understand numbers 0–1,000,000 at speed, especially 70–99
- ✓ Say prices in dollars and cents the Canadian way
- ✓ Give dates, days, months and years
- ✓ Tell time using both the 24-hour clock and everyday expressions

Number	French	Literally
70	soixante-dix seventy	sixty-ten
71	soixante et onze seventy-one	sixty and eleven
75	soixante-quinze	sixty-fifteen
80	quatre-vingts eighty	four twenties
81	quatre-vingt-un	four-twenty-one (no "et", no s)
90	quatre-vingt-dix ninety	four-twenty-ten
92	quatre-vingt-douze	four-twenty-twelve
99	quatre-vingt-dix-neuf	four-twenty-ten-nine

Time	Official	Conversational
8:15	huit heures quinze eight fifteen	huit heures et quart quarter past eight
12:30	douze heures trente twelve thirty	midi et demi half past noon
15:45	quinze heures quarante-cinq fifteen forty-five (3:45 p.m.)	quatre heures moins le quart quarter to four
20:50	vingt heures cinquante twenty fifty (8:50 p.m.)	neuf heures moins dix ten to nine

KEY PHRASES

vingt et un, trente-quatre, quarante-huit, cinquante-cinq, soixante-six
21, 34, 48, 55, 66

Ça coûte combien ? — Quarante-neuf dollars quatre-vingt-quinze, taxes en sus.

How much is it? — \$49.95 plus tax.

Le loyer est de mille trois cents dollars par mois.

The rent is \$1,300 a month.

Vous avez un rabais de quinze pour cent.

You get a 15% discount.

Mon rendez-vous est le mardi 3 juin à 14 h 30.

My appointment is on Tuesday, June 3 at 2:30 p.m.

La date limite est le premier septembre.

The deadline is September 1.

Ça coûte quatre-vingt-dix-neuf dollars, taxes comprises.

It's \$99, taxes included.

Mon numéro, c'est le cinq, un, quatre, cinq, cinq, cinquante-dix-sept, quatre-vingt-deux.

My number is 514 555-7782 (the last four digits said in pairs).

Je suis né le vingt-trois novembre mille neuf cent quatre-vingt-onze.

I was born on November 23, 1991.

Le rendez-vous est jeudi prochain à quinze heures trente.

The appointment is next Thursday at 3:30 p.m.

AVOID THESE MISTAKES

~~X quatre-vingt~~ (for 80)

✓ quatre-vingts

80 takes an s — but it drops when another number follows: quatre-vingt-un.

~~X vingt-un, quatre-vingt-et-un~~

✓ vingt et un, quatre-vingt-un

21, 31... 61 and 71 use "et"; 81 and 91 don't. (The 1990 spelling reform also allows hyphens everywhere: vingt-et-un.)

~~X Lundi, Janvier~~

✓ lundi, janvier

No capitals for days and months.

~~X le un mai~~

✓ le premier mai

Only the 1st uses premier.

~~X \$12.99~~

✓ 12,99 \$

Canadian French: comma decimal, \$ after the amount.

~~X deux-milles~~

✓ deux mille

mille never takes s.

MUST-KNOW WORDS

le prix price

la semaine prochaine next week

coûter to cost

il y a trois jours three days ago

le rabais / la réduction discount

dans deux semaines in two weeks

taxes en sus / comprises plus tax / tax included

à l'heure / en retard / en avance on time / late / early

le reçu receipt

midi / minuit noon / midnight

la date limite deadline

la fin de semaine weekend (Qc)

TIP

To process 90s fast in listening, train yourself to hear **quatre-vingt-** as a single "80 +" chunk, then add what follows. Drill with prices and phone numbers daily for a week.